MILITARY SPECIFICATION

# CARTRIDGE, 57MM, CANISTER, T25E5 LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the loading, assembling and packing for one type of cartridge designated as Cartridge, 57MM, Canister,T25E5 for use in M18 and M18A1 Rifles.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-A-2550 | - | Ammunition and Special Weapons, General Specification for |
| MIL-I-45607 | - | Inspection Equipment, Supply and Maintenance of |

STANDARDS

MILITARY

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-STD-105 | - | Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes (ABC-STD-105) |
| MIL-STD-109 | - | Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions |
| MIL-STD-414 | - | Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Variables for Percent Defective |
| MIL-STD-1168- | | Lot Numbering of Ammunition |
| MIL-STD-1235- | | Single and Multilevel Continuous Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes |

FSC: 1310

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DRAWINGS

ARMY

9215708 - Cartridge, 57MM, Canister, T25E5, for Rifles, M18 and M18A1

9216239 - Container, Ammunition, Fiber, M362, for Cartridge, 57MM, Canister, T25E5, for Rifles M18 and M18A1

9216240 - Box, Packing, Ammunition, for Cartridge, 57MM, Canister, T25E5, for Rifles M18 and M18A1

PUBLICATIONS

ARMY

ET-9215708 - Equipment Tabulation

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.-Materials and parts shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Cartridges.-The cartridges shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (dwg.) 9215708 and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Primer Tightness.-The primer shall remain intact after being subjected to a force of 50 pounds.

3.4 Liner Damaged.-The liner shall not be damaged to the extent that propellant can escape, as evidenced by the passage of 5 cubic centimeters of air through the liner in a one-second interval, using a 2-pounds per square inch (psi) pressure differential.

3.5 Propellant Weight.-The weight of the propellant shall not differ by more than plus or minus (+) 0.03 ounce avoirdupois from that designated by the loading authorization for the particular lot of propellant used.



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3.6 Proving Ground.-The cartridge shall comply with the following requirements when tested as specified in 4.3.4.

3.6.1 Functioning.-The cartridge shall function at a distance less than 10 feet from the muzzle, as evidenced by metal parts separation of the canister in flight.

3.6.2 Pressure.-No individual pressure obtained when fired at 70 degrees Fahrenheit (F) shall be greater than 6925 pounds per square inch (psi) or less than 5675 psi.

3.6.3 Security.-There shall be no breakup or separation of the canister assembly in the rifle bore sufficient to render the rifle unserviceable (See 6.6).

3.7 Profile and Alignment.-The cartridge shall freely enter a complete round profile and alignment gage.

3.8 Workmanship.-All parts and assemblies shall be fabricated and finished in a thorough, workmanlike manner and shall be free of cracks, chips, dirt, grease, rust and other foreign material. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any of the parts, nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agent. The painting and marking shall be restored by the assembly contractor on any components furnished to him painted and marked, when such paintings and markings have been marred or obliterated.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.-Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to Standard MIL-STD-109 to define terms used herein. The provisions of Specification MIL-A-2550 shall apply.



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4.1.1 Submission of Product.-At the time each completed lot of items deliverable under the contract is submitted to the Government for acceptance, the contractor shall supply the following information accompanied by a certificate which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

a. A statement that the lot complies with all of the quality assurance provisions specified within this specification.

b. Drawing, specification number and date, together with an identification and date of changes thereto.

c. A statement that all material purchased by the contractor meets requirements, when such material is controlled by Government or commercial specifications referenced in any of the contractual documents, and that certificates of conformance are on file and available for review.

d. Number of items in the lot.

e. Date submitted.

The certificate shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certificate submitted shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certificates unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.2 Quality Conformance Inspection

4.2.1 Lot Formation.-The term "inspection lot", as used in this specification, is defined as an essentially homogeneous collection of units of product from which a representative sample is drawn and inspected to determine conformance with applicable requirements. The sample selected shall represent only that quantity of units from which the sample was drawn, and shall not be construed to represent any prior or subsequent quantities presented for inspection. Homogeneity shall be considered to exist provided the inspection lot has been produced by one manufacturer, in one unchanged process, using the same materials and methods, in accordance with the same drawings, same drawing revisions, smae specifications and same specification revisions, and complies with the provisions for submission of product as specified in Standard MIL-STD-105.



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Changes to the process, specification or drawing not affecting safety, performance, interchangeability or storage, as determined by the Government, shall not be deemed to alter the homogeneity of an inspection lot. All material submitted for inspection in accordance with this specification shall comply with the homogeneity criteria specified herein, regardless of the type of sampling procedure which is being applied to determine conformance with requirements. Lot numbering, as required, shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1168. Each inspection lot of loaded cartridges shall contain:

a. Cartridge cases of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer in accordance with the same drawing and drawing revision, same specification and specification revision.

b. Canisters of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer in accordance with the same drawing and drawing revision, same specification and specification revision.

c. Propellant from not more than one lot from one manufacturer.

d. Loaded primers of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.

4.2.2 Examination.-The examinations listed in the following subparagraphs shall be performed on inspection lots (See 4.2.1) of the components or assemblies designated in the applicable paragraph headings. Inspection for Critical Defects (and Major Defects, when so specified) shall be 100 percent. Sampling plans for Major and Minor Defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except that continuous sampling plans in accordance with MIL-STD-1235 may be used if approved by the Government. Instead of applying the AQL's designated herein to the groups of Major and Minor Defects listed, the contractor may elect to apply AQL's to individual defects using an AQL of 0.40 percent for each Major Defect and an AQL of 0.65 percent for each Minor Defect When this method is elected, it shall be applied to all of the Major and Minor Defects listed in the applicable subparagraph of this section, except where 100 percent inspection is specified, and be documented as part of the contractor's inspection system. Equipment necessary for the performance of the inspections listed shall be in accordance with 4.2.4.



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4.2.2.1 Primer, Prior to Assembly to Cartridge Case (See dwg. 8839466, covering a detail of dwg. 9215708).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. (See 6.2) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | | | |
| 1. | One or more flash holes missing..... | Visual | 01001 |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Paper liner flash tube damaged..... | Visual | 01002 |
| Minor: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 201. | Evidence of poor workmanship (See 3.8)..... | Visual | 01003 |

4.2.2.2 Cartridge Case, Prior to Loading Propellant (See dwg. 10535911, covering a detail of dwg. 9215708).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: None defined. | | | |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Primer damaged..... | Visual | 02001 |
| Minor: | AQL 1.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Foreign matter on interior of liner. | Visual | 02002 |
| 202. | Foreign matter in charge..... | Visual | 02003 |
| 203. | Evidence of poor workmanship..... | Visual | 02004 |

4.2.2.3 Cartridge Case with Propelling Charge Liner Closed and Sealed (See dwg. 9215708).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: None defined. | | | |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Propelling charge missing..... | Visual | 03001 |
| 102. | Liner improperly closed..... | Visual | 03002 |
| Minor: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 201. | Evidence of poor workmanship..... | Visual | 03003 |



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4.2.2.4 Cartridge Assembly (See dwg. 9215708).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | | | |
| 1. | Primer above flush | Gage | 04001 |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Primer depth below max. | Gage | 04002 |
| Minor: | AQL 1.0 percent | | |
| 201. | Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable, including incorrect color code | Visual | 04003 |
| 202. | Evidence of poor workmanship | Visual | 04004 |

4.2.2.5 Unsealed Fiber Container (See dwg. 9216239).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: None defined. | | | |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Packing component missing | Visual | 05001 |
| Minor: | AQL 1.0 percent | | |
| 201. | Round excessively tight in container | Manual | 05002 |
| 202. | Evidence of poor workmanship | Visual | 05003 |

4.2.2.6 Sealed Fiber Container (See dwg. 9216239).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: None defined. | | | |
| Major: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 101. | Container cut or damaged through all asphalt impregnated layers | Visual | 06001 |
| 102. | Tape incomplete or badly wrinkled | Visual | 06002 |
| 103. | Metal end loose or distorted | Visual | 06003 |



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| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Minor: | AQL 2.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Tear tab missing or improper | Visual | 06004 |
| 202. | Gap between cover and body of container | Visual | 06005 |
| 203. | Color of tape incorrect | Visual | 06006 |
| 204. | Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable | Visual | 06007 |
| 205. | Contents loose | Visual | 06008 |

4.2.2.7 Sealed Wood Packing Box (See dwg. 9216240).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | None defined. | | |
| Major: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 101. | Box damaged | Visual | 07001 |
| 102. | Hardware or strapping missing, broken or loose | Visual-Manual | 07002 |
| 103. | Boards loose or nails protruding | Visual | 07003 |
| Minor: | AQL 2.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Hardware improperly engaged | Visual-Manual | 07004 |
| 202. | Strapping improperly assembled | Visual-Manual | 07005 |
| 203. | Car seal missing, unsealed or improperly positioned | Visual-Manual | 07006 |
| 204. | Handle missing or insecure | Visual | 07007 |
| 205. | Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable | Visual | 07008 |

4.2.3 Testing

4.2.3.1 Check Test for Deterioration of Primers.-If the total elapsed time between the original acceptance of any primer lot and the assembly of that primer lot into complete round cartridges exceeds two years, or if the primers have been subjected to adverse conditions, however brief, at any time since previous tests, the primer lot shall be subjected to and must satisfactorily pass the check test for deterioration specified in the applicable specification immediately before the primer is assembled into the cartridge (See 6.4).



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4.2.3.2 Primer Tightness (See 3.3) - Critical Defect - Code No. 02005.-This test shall be performed 100 percent. Each primer, after insertion into the cartridge case, shall be subjected to a push test in accordance with 4.3.1. If any sample assembly fails to meet the applicable requirement, that assembly shall be removed from the lot. This test must be conducted prior to depth of primer element inspections.

4.2.3.3 Liner

4.2.3.3.1 Liner Damaged to the Extent Propellant Can Escape - Critical Defect - Code No. 03004.-This test shall be performed 100 percent, using equipment and procedures specified in 4.2.4. If any liner fails to meet the requirement of 3.4, the assembly containing the liner shall be removed from the lot.

4.2.3.4 Propellant Weight (See 3.5) - Major Defect - Code No. 03005.-The propellant shall be weighed and check-weighed 100 percent. The check-weighing shall be accomplished independently of the original weighing and, if performed manually, shall be performed by another operator. Any propelling charge which fails to comply with the applicable requirements shall be classed defective and removed from the lot, subject to correction prior to resubmission. Equipment shall be in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.3.5 Bullet Pull (See 9215708) - Major Defect - Code No. 04005.-The sampling plan for this test shall be in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-414, Section B, Part II, Table B3, Code Letter F, and an AQL of 1.5 percent. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.2, with equipment in accordance with 4.2.4 to determine compliance with the requirement specified on the drawing.

4.2.3.6 Torque (See 9215708) - Major Defect - Code No. 04006.-The sampling plan for this test shall be in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-105, and an AQL of 0.40 percent. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.3, with equipment in accordance with 4.2.4, to determine compliance with the requirement specified on the drawing.



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4.2.3.7 Profile and Alignment (See 3.7) - Major Defect - Code No. 04007.-The cartridges shall be gaged 100 percent for profile and alignment. Any cartridge which fails to meet the applicable requirement shall be classed defective and removed from the lot. Equipment shall be in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.3.8 Proving Ground.-The following test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.4 (See 6.5).

4.2.3.8.1 Functioning (See 3.6.1) - Major Defect -Code No. 04008.

4.2.3.8.1.1 Beginning with the first lot produced and continuing until three consecutive lots have complied with the acceptance criteria specified herein, 25 cartridges shall be randomly selected from each lot for this test. If any cartridge fails to comply with the applicable requirements, the lot shall be rejected.

4.2.3.8.1.2 After three consecutive lots have complied with the acceptance criteria of 4.2.3.8.1.1, ten cartridges shall be randomly selected from each lot for this test. If any cartridge fails to comply with the applicable requirements, the lot shall be rejected. In the event that three successive lots fail to meet the requirements of 4.2.3.8.1.2, the sampling provisions of 4.2.3.8.1.1 shall again apply. When three successive lots have again successfully passed the requirements, the provisions of 4.2.3.8.1.2 shall be reinstated.

4.2.3.8.2 Pressure - Major Defect - Code No 04009.-Those sample cartridges fired for functioning shall be measured for maximum (max.) chamber pressure in accordance with 4.3.4. If any sample fails to meet the requirement in 3.6.2, the lot shall be rejected.

4.2.3.8.3 Security (See 3.6.3) - Major Defect - Code No. 04010.-All cartridges fired for functioning shall be observed for security. If any canister fails to comply with the applicable requirement, the lot shall be rejected.

4.2.3.8.4 Refiring.-If for any reason the proof director considers that the test conditions have detrimentally affected the test results, he shall declare the results invalid and perform a new test on additonal sample rounds as required.



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4.2.4 Inspection Equipment.-The inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed in this section is identified by Equipment Tabulation Number ET-9207517 (See 6.3).

4.2.4.1 Government Rights to Documentation.-Inspection equipment drawings and lists provided and revised in accordance with the requirements of the ET may be used by DOD activities for design, procurement, manufacture, testing, evaluation, production and receiving inspection, overhaul, shipping, storage, identification of stock, ordering and storage of replacement parts, inspection of items at overhaul, general maintenance of equipment, construction, survey and whenever inspection equipment drawings are needed.

4.2.4.2 Supply and Maintenance.-Supply and maintenance of the equipment listed in the ET shall be in accordance with Specification MIL-I-45607.

4.2.4.3 Government Use of Contractor's Inspection Equipment.-The contractor shall make available to the Government all inspection equipment necessary for determining conformance with contract requirements. Personnel for operating the equipment, and verification of its accuracy, shall be supplied by the contractor for the performance of examination or test by the Government.

4.3 Test Methods and Procedures

4.3.1 Primer Tightness.-Appropriate safety precautions shall be observed when conducting this test. A force of 50 minus (-) 2 pounds shall be applied to the primer in a rearward direction. The rate of travel of the machine head shall be 0.100 to 0.125 inch per minute, inclusive. The force shall be applied in an axial direction. Alternative test methods that assure conformance to the specified requirement may be submitted to the Government for approval (See 6.3.4).

4.3.2 Bullet Pull.-The sample cartridges shall be tested for security of the crimp of the cartridge case to the canister by applying the load in the axial direction in such a manner as to avoid possible loosening of other joints. The rate of travel of the testing machine head shall be .100 to .125 inch per minute, inclusive.



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4.3.3 Torque.-The torque shall be applied while holding the parts immediately adjacent to the joints being tested so as to avoid possible loosening of other joints. The joint under test shall be marked to provide a means for detection of any movement between the adjacent parts. Any discernible movement between adjacent parts shall be regarded as a torque test failure.

4.3.4 Proving Ground.-These tests shall be conducted at a Government proving ground in accordance with the Acceptance Test Procedure Supplement CR-57R-2. The cartridges shall be conditioned to 70 ± 2°F for 24 hours. They shall be fired within five minutes after being removed from the conditioning box. They shall be fired in a rifle for which the round is standard, positioned on a ballistic pendulum. The maximum chamber pressure shall be taken by placing two pressure gages under the cartridge case and as far forward as possible. The pressure shall be reported as maximum piezoelectric equivalent pressure. Adequate photographic coverage shall be provided to observe for canister functioning. Visual examination of the rifle tube shall be provided before firing and after each round is fired to determine conformance to the security requirements. Recoil in pound-seconds shall be recorded for each round fired for informational purposes. An acceptable lot exhibiting one or more misfires shall be referred for evaluation and final disposition.

## 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

### 5.1 Preservation and Packaging

5.1.1 Level A.-The cartridges shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with dwg. 9216239.

### 5.2 Packing

5.2.1 Level A.-The cartridges in containers shall be packed in accordance with dwg. 9216240.

5.3 Marking.-Marking shall be in accordance with dwg. 9216239 or dwg. 9216240, as applicable.



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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering Data.-Procurement documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Data Cards.-Data cards shall be prepared for each lot in accordance with the information specified in Standard MIL-STD-1167.

6.2 Inspection Code Numbers.-The five-digit code numbers assigned to the inspections herein are to facilitate future data collection and analysis by the Government.

6.3 Inspection Equipment Designs.-Inspection equipment designs are of two types: Army designs and contractor designs. Wherever required, Army designs are designated by drawing numbers on the Equipment Lists referenced on the ET, and are mandatory for use by the contractor. Design responsibility for all other inspection equipment is assigned to the contractor. Equipment to be designed by the contractor is designated "CD".

6.3.1 Army designs.-Mandatory Army designs may consist of any of the following:

a. Detailed drawings which completely depict all information necessary for the fabrication and use of the item of inspection equipment.

b. A source control drawing or a specification control drawing as defined in MIL-STD-100.

c. An envelope drawing, as defined in MIL-STD-100, which establishes the criteria which a detailed design shall meet. When envelope drawings are specified, the contractor shall prepare designs which comply with the criteria therein.

6.3.2 Contractor Designs.-Contractor designs are required for all inspection equipment for which Army designs are not specified, and may include commercial equipment which the contractor proposes to use. (Commercial equipment is defined as unmodified inspection equipment which is catalogued and available for purchase by the general public.) Contractor



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designs shall include, as applicable, operating instructions, calibration procedures and maintenance procedures. Commercial equipment shall be fully described by means of catalog sheets or the like. This information will include illustrations and engineering data adequate for evaluation. Designs shall be prepared for any special fixture(s) required to be used with commercial equipment or with Army designs if not otherwise covered thereby. Designs shall be of the category and form (per MIL-D-1000) specified in the Contract Data Requirements Lists (DD Form 1423). The contractor is referred to MIL-HDBK-204, "Inspection Equipment Design" for guidance. The specification number and the applicable five-digit defect code number from Section 4 of this specification shall be referenced on each contractor design.

6.3.3 Submission for approval.-Contractor designs shall be approved by the Government prior to fabricating or procuring of the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval within the time frame and with the distribution specified in the Contract Data Requirements List (DD Form 1423). Partial submission of inspection equipment designs is permissible and encouraged. However, the completion data for design review will be based on the date of the final submission of designs. Picatinny Arsenal design review will be accomplished normally within one month after receipt.

6.3.4 Alternative methods shall be submitted for approval to the Commanding Officer, Picatinny Arsenal, ATTN: SMUPA-QA-A-A, Dover, New Jersey, 07801.

6.4 Cost of Check Test.-The contracting officer shall arrange for the contractor to be reimbursed for the expense incurred in the performance of the check tests. The test shall be conducted at Government expense without cost to the contractor who loaded the primers or to the contractor assembling the cartridges, and shall not constitute a basis for rejection against either contractor, except where deterioration has occurred as a direct result of carelessness in handling, storage, etc., permitted while the primer lot was under the jurisdiction of either contractor.



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6.5 Proving Ground Test Summary

| Phase | Sample Size | Requirements |
|---|---|---|
| Function | 25* 10 | a. Function (See 3.6.1)<br>b. Pressure (See 3.6.2)<br>c. Security (See 3.6.3)<br>d. Recoil Momentum for Information (See 4.3.4)<br>e. Misfires for Referral (See 4.3.4) |
| Pressure | See Above | |
| Security | See Above | |

*First three lots or tightened inspection

6.6 Unserviceable.-Any bulges in the tube of the weapon resulting from early canister breakup that are readily visible shall be considered sufficient to render the weapon unserviceable. Borescope photographs shall be taken of such an occurrence for attachment to the firing record.

6.7 Submission of Test Data and Ammunition Data Cards.-In addition to the normal distribution of records, when the cartridge is procured by the Department of the Army, one copy of all ballistic test data and ammunition data cards shall be forwarded to each of the following:

Commanding Officer
Picatinny Arsenal
ATTN: SMUPA-QA-A-A
SMUPA-AD-E-C-6
Dover, New Jersey 07801

6.8 Supersession Data.-This specification includes the requirements of Purchase Description PA-PD-2845, dated 8 April 1966.

Custodian:
Army-MU

Preparing Activity:
Army-MU

FSC: 1310-A-015



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